Redesign v2: two directions

ZHA-4181, 2026-10-28. Zhafron asked for a UI that is responsive, fluent, tidy and easy to use, and handed every design choice to the engineer (16:17Z). Both options below were judged against the same gates (DESIGN.md), on the v0.3.5 defect list.

What was wrong in v0.3.5

#	Defect	Where
1	Alarm bell is an emoji (U+1F514), the only colour glyph on the page	`alarms.js`
2	Playback and Cloud recordings share the clock icon; Devices has none	`playback.js`, `recordings.js`, `device-admin.js`
3	Hand-drawn icon sprite: 27 symbols, mixed stroke weights	`index.html`
4	Alarm sheet, playback and cloud recordings inject their own CSS with hex colours and two tokens that do not exist (`--bg-1`, `--dim`): they ignore the light theme	three scripts
5	Pressed, selected and checked look like hover (ink on ink)	`style.css`
6	Text at 10-11 px in the badge, pad notes and alarm footer	several
7	6 px and 10 px steps break the 4 px rhythm	`style.css`
8	Sign-in, settings and the top bar scroll sideways at 320-390 px; auto grid uses 3 columns at every width	measured by the responsive gate

Option 1: Graphite + one accent (chosen)

Keep the neutral graphite page so the camera picture stays the brightest thing on screen, and give interaction one colour of its own: blue for primary, pressed, selected and checked, with a soft fill behind it. Red stays recording and alarm count only, green online, yellow stale. One icon family (Lucide), a 4 px grid, 12 px floor for text, 160/200 ms motion.

- Fixes all eight defects without moving a control, so every flow a user knows stays where it was.
- Cost: CSS +1.3 KB gzip; JS -1.3 KB (no injected style strings).
- Contrast: 76 of 76 pairs pass; the weakest is the light focus ring on the stage, 3.31:1 against a 3:1 floor.

Option 2: Surface cards

Put the live picture, the controls and every sheet on raised cards with a 16 px radius over a tinted page, accent-coloured headers, larger 48 px controls.

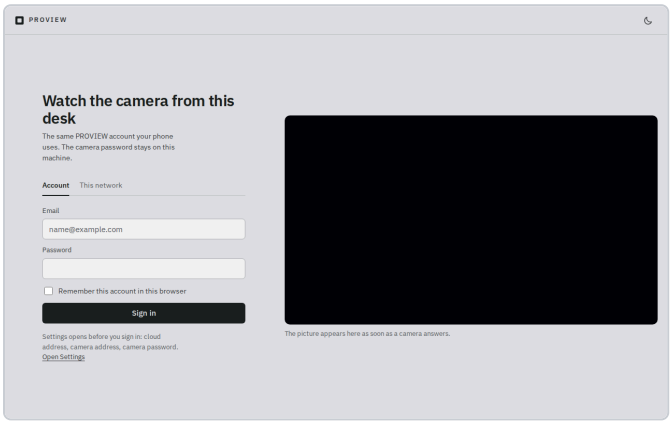
- More "app-like" in a screenshot, but cards add an edge and a shadow around the picture, which v1 measured as the element that must win; the control row grows by 8 px, which costs the picture height on 1280x800 and below.
- Tinted pages lower ink-3 contrast in the light theme (the hint text was the tightest pair already).
- Every screen moves, so muscle memory from v0.3.5 is lost for no gain in a task.

Why option 1

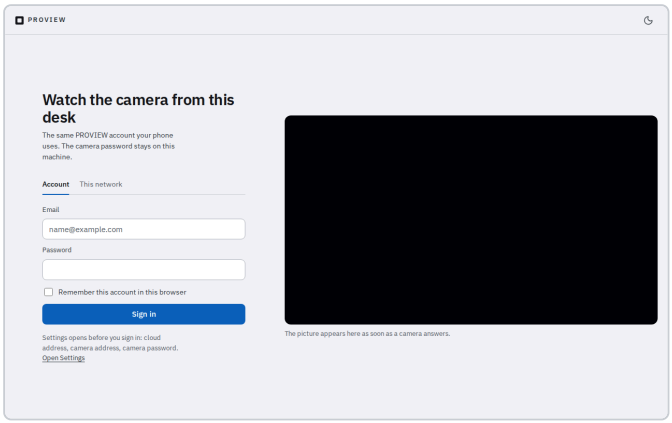
The complaints were that things did not match (icons), were not smooth (state changes, motion) and did not fit (narrow screens), not that the layout was wrong. Option 1 answers each with a measured change and keeps the picture as the largest, brightest element. Screens rendered from the real build are in `e2e/tests/visual.spec.ts-snapshots/` and `e2e/tests/touch.spec.ts-snapshots/`; `proview-redesign-v2.pdf` shows them side by side with the defect list.

Before (v0.3.5 UI, 1edca06) and after (v2, 89976a1)

Sign-in, 1280x800, light

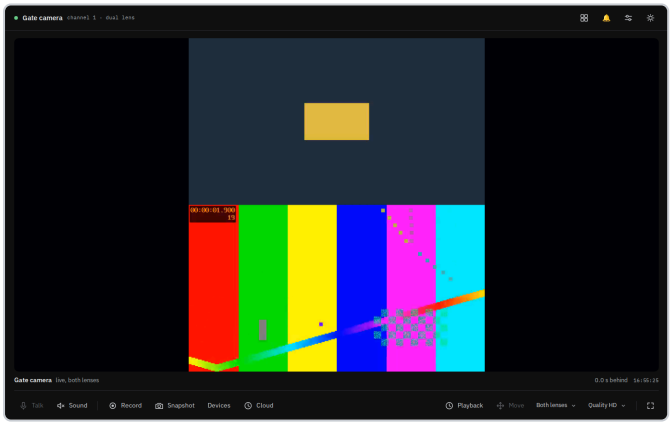


v0.3.5

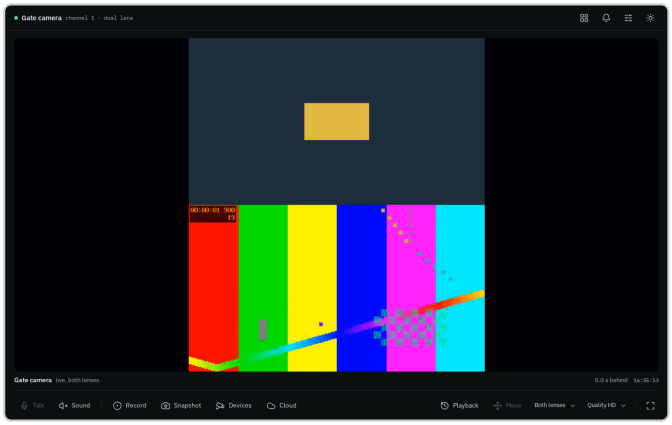


v2

Live, 1440x900, dark

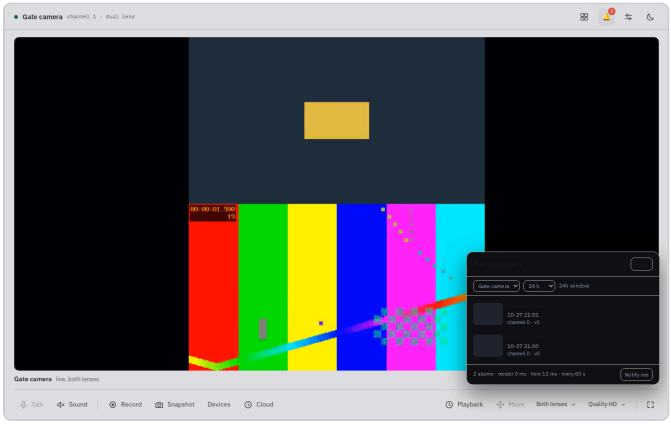


v0.3.5

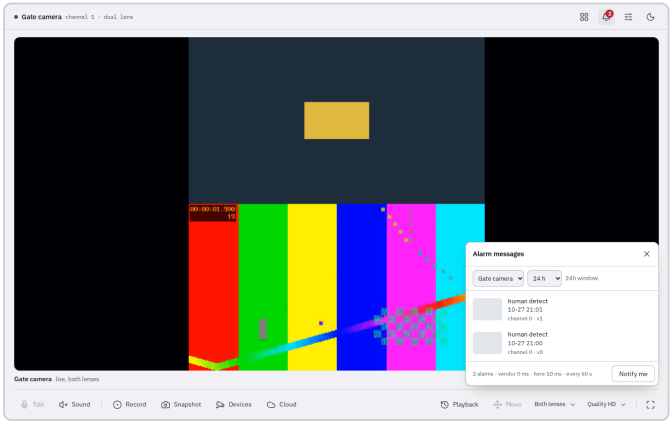


v2

Live with the alarm sheet, 1440x900, light

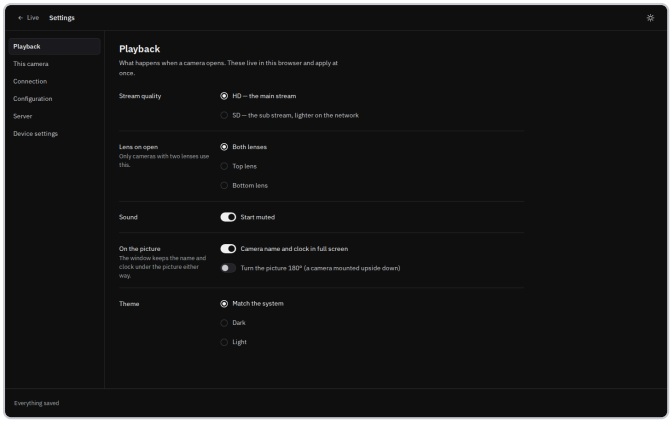


v0.3.5

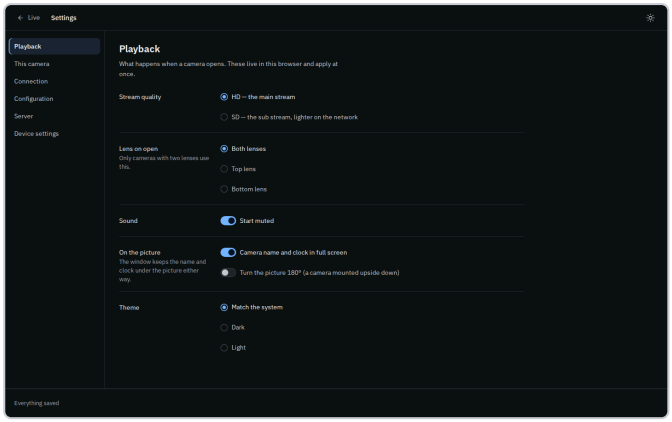


v2

Settings, 1440x900, dark

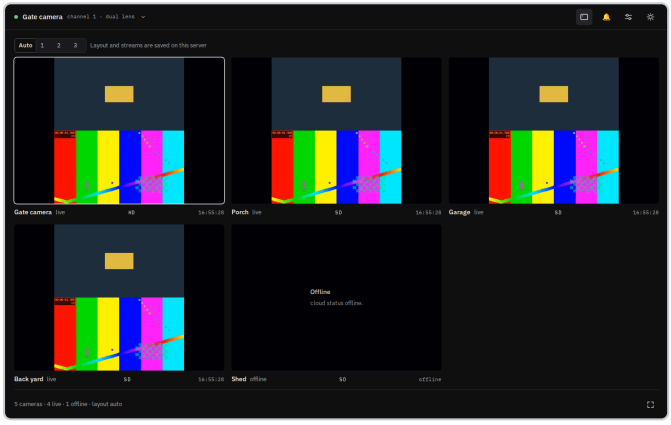


v0.3.5

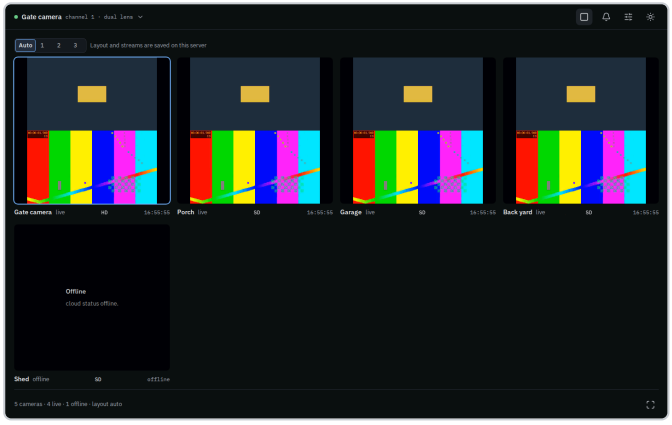


v2

Every camera, 1440x900, dark

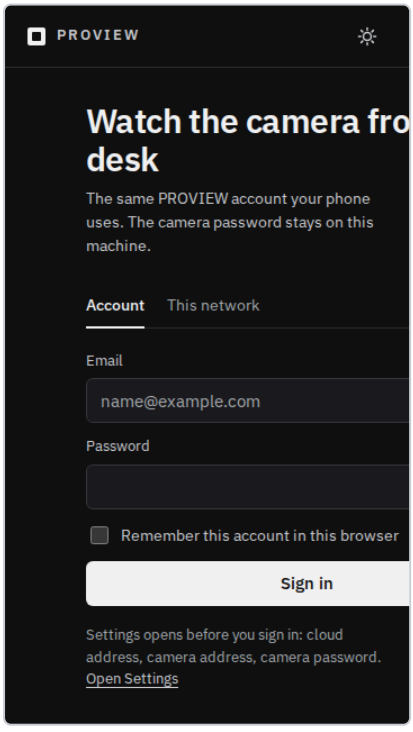


v0.3.5

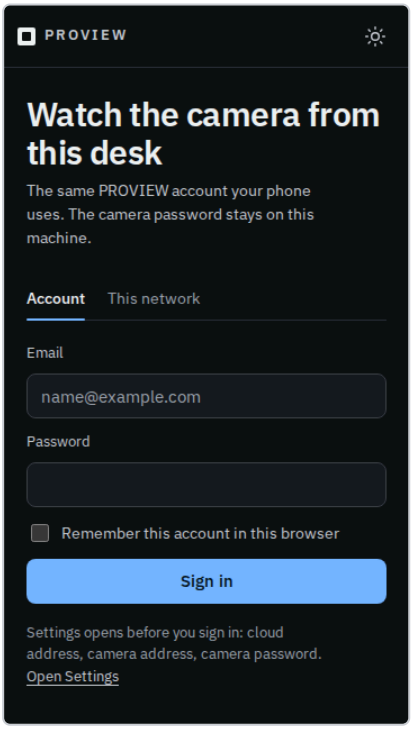


v2

Phone 360x640, dark: sign-in

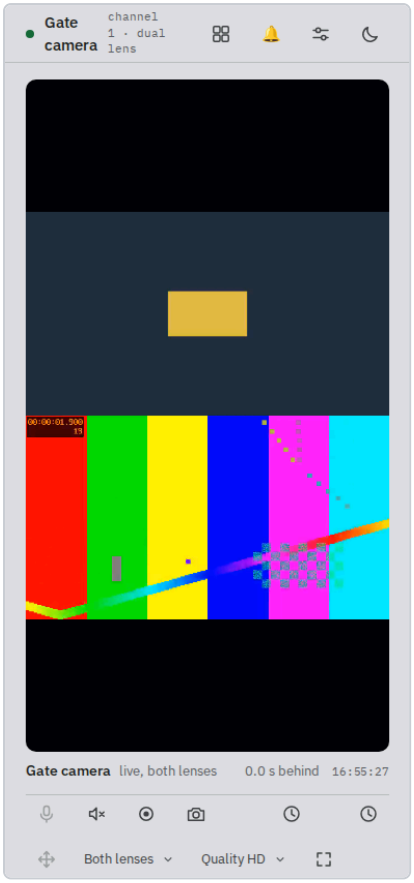


v0.3.5

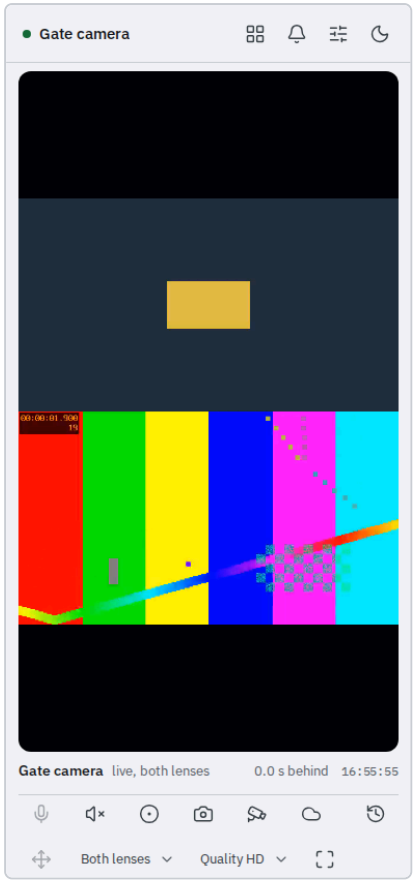


v2

Phone 390x844, light: live

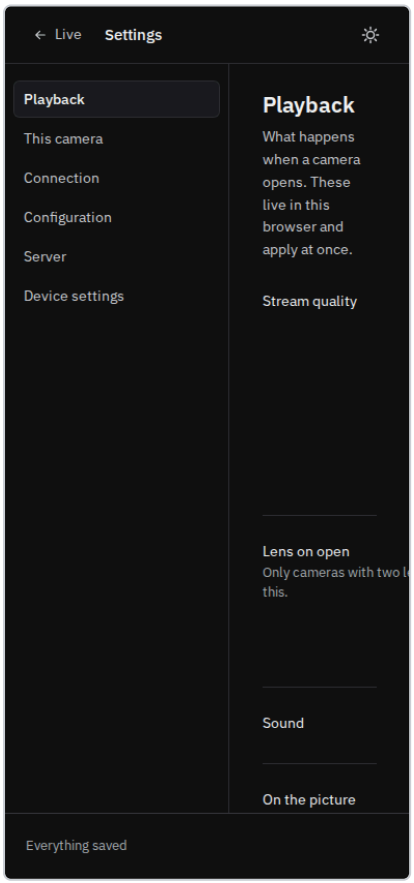


v0.3.5

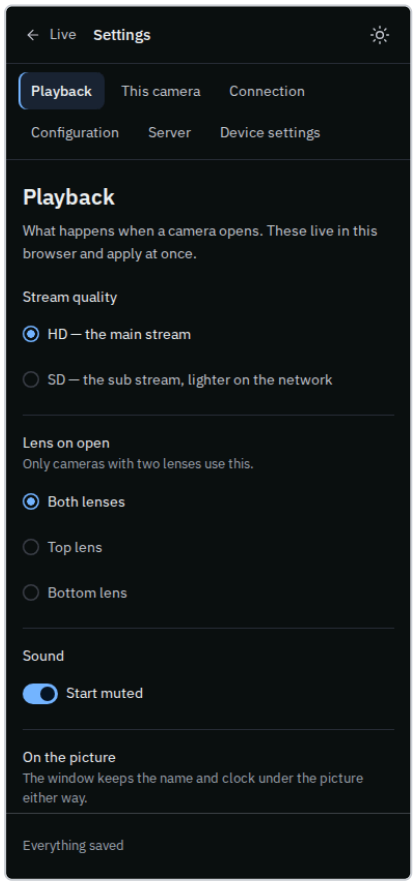


v2

Phone 390x844, dark: settings



v0.3.5



v2